A Model of Christian Charity

John Winthrop · 1630

Source: John Winthrop, "A Model of Christian Charity" (1630). Public domain. Closing passage of the sermon (original spelling).

> Aboard the ship Arbella bound for Massachusetts Bay, the Puritan leader urged the colonists to build a godly community bound by love — famously calling it "a city upon a hill" on which the eyes of all the world would be fixed.

COMPLETE TEXT — UNEDITED

Now the onely way to avoyde this shipwracke, and to provide for our posterity, is to followe the counsell of Micah, to doe justly, to love mercy, to walk humbly with our God. For this end, wee must be knitt together in this work as one man. Wee must entertaine each other in brotherly Affection, wee must be willing to abridge our selves of our superfluities, for the supply of others necessities. Wee must uphold a familiar Commerce together in all meekenes, gentlenes, patience and liberality.

Wee must delight in eache other, make other's conditions our owne, rejoyce together, mourne together, labour and suffer together, allwayes haveing before our eyes our Commission and Community in the worke, our Community as members of the same body. Soe shall wee keepe the unitie of the spirit in the bond of peace. The Lord will be our God, and delight to dwell among Us as his owne people, and will command a blessing upon us in all our wayes.

For wee must Consider that wee shall be as a Citty upon a hill. The eies of all people are uppon Us, soe that if wee shall deale falsely with our god in this worke wee have undertaken, and soe cause him to withdrawe his present help from us, wee shall be made a story and a by-word through the world. Wee shall open the mouthes of enemies to speake evill of the wayes of god, and all professours for God's sake. Wee shall shame the faces of many of god's worthy servants, and cause theire prayers to be turned into Cursses upon us till wee be consumed out of the good land whither wee are a goeing.